



University Senate Minutes

October 22nd, 2025
Virtual Meeting
4:00 – 5:30 pm

The chair opened the meeting by welcoming everyone in attendance to the meeting. To officially begin the meeting, the chair stated, *"I acknowledge with respect the Onondaga Nation, firekeepers of the Haudenosaunee, the indigenous people on whose ancestral lands Syracuse University now stands."*

The chair reviewed the general instructions for virtual meetings. She noted that she had recently hosted a number of orientation meetings for new and returning senators to help familiarize senators with the operations of the University Senate. The chair noted that she had asked all new senators that had attended these meetings to review the Senate bylaws to become more familiar with the roles of the committees, and to come to Senate meetings having read the materials and committee reports. She asked that senators be prepared to engage in conversations around these reports, particularly those topics and areas for discussion.

The chair stated that in order to support this engagement, we need to continue to build an atmosphere of trust in these meetings. She directed senators to the chat where the ground rules for communication had been posted. She stated that the ground rules would be posted at the start of every meeting in the chat for review.

The chair shared that during the recent orientation meetings one question was consistently asked in every meeting, and that was about votes, and whether or not they were always public. The chair referenced the September Senate meeting and the technical difficulty with our voting system. The chair stated that when the Senate met in person, voting would be conducted using the clicker system, and during virtual meetings on Zoom, voting would be conducted using Zoom polls, which are anonymous.

The chair added that Zoom polls were also a challenge, as the Senate meetings routinely have many people in the room who are not senators, and we don't have a mechanism to tell, or to select who those polls are sent out to. The chair addressed the non-senator guests in attendance, stating that she was grateful for their interest in the University Senate, but she asked that they not participate in any vote or poll raised during the meeting.

The chair added that when necessary, deliberations would move to Qualtrics for certain votes, in situations where we want to ensure the process. The chair acknowledges the work of Senate manager, Kelly Bogart, to move the University Senate to the Teams platform for all Senate materials. Senators received an email the week prior to the Senate meeting, which included

instructions to access the Teams folder. The chair noted that if anyone was having trouble, technical support could be arranged.

The chair went on to report that moving forward, committee slides would also be available in Teams a minimum of two hours prior to the full Senate meetings. For those who are interested in accessing those by 2:00 p.m. before Senate meetings, they will be available. There is a caveat that these slides may need to be modified or adjusted right up to the meeting, but we will provide what we have.

The chair reported that last week, many tenured and tenure-track faculty should have received an email from herself and Senators Eileen Schell and Emily Stokes-Rees, which included information and a ballot for the Provost Advisory Committee on Promotion and Tenure. The chair asked senators to please be sure to review that material and complete that ballot by October 31st.

Also mentioned by email late last week, there is a vacancy on the Agenda Committee. The chair thanked Senator Crystal Bartolovich for her service on the Senate and on the Agenda Committee this past year. The chair shared the list of current members of the Agenda Committee with the membership.

The chair shared that many people were nominated, and of those, four individuals had agreed to serve, if elected. The chair shared the names of the four senators, thanking Melissa Almeyda, Andrew London, Hua Jiang, and Brian Taylor for being willing to have their names on the ballot for the seat on the Agenda Committee.

The chair asked if there are additional nominations at this time. A senator was recognized by the chair, however the senator indicated that they were not making a nomination, but instead had a question on an unrelated topic. The chair asked the senator to hold their question until after the nomination information had been completed.

The chair reiterated her question regarding additional nominations at this time. As there were none, the chair stated that the election vote would be held through Qualtrics. She noted that the Qualtrics poll would be distributed by email and would include brief biographies on each of the nominees. The chair shared her appreciation for senators' participation in the election process in the coming days.

The chair raised the issue of the vote on the minutes from the September Senate meeting. The chair asked if there was any discussion on the minutes.

The senator who had previously asked to be recognized, did so again to address the September meeting minutes. The senator stated that they wanted to request either an amendment to the minutes or a rectification based on their understanding of what it means to be recognized and have the floor, and having the floor given to a senator is not the way that it was described in the September minutes. The senator identified themselves as the senator who asked a question after the discussion of the final motion that had been presented as new business.

The senator went on to state that at the September meeting, it was their understanding that there was not a formulated question from the chair pertaining to whether or not there was new business. According to the senator, since the formulated question "Is there any new business?" was not uttered during the meeting, senators were not in a position to raise new business. The senator stated that it was their recollection and understanding, there is the

need to ask whether there was new business, which the senator felt was skipped. The senator stated that by the time they understood that the Senate was discussing new business, the opportunity for the senator to raise new business, or any other senator to raise new business had not been presented.

The senator also noted that they disagree with the way in which the chair and the Senate parliamentarian understand what happened in the moment. The senator felt that they had been recognized and had not yielded the floor to anyone, and they asked their question. The senator believed that the Senate had to do something with the question that was asked, either to postpone discussion of that question for the next meeting, or to vote on what to do with it. The senator stated that the minutes do not reflect their recollection of what transpired.

The chair thanked the senator for their comments and asked if there was a specific way that the senator would like the minutes modified.

The senator responded that the minutes should reflect that the question of whether there was new business or not was never asked, and the senator thinks its an important question to ask during Senate meetings. The chair thanked the senator and asked again if there was any other discussion arising from the minutes. As there was none, the chair stated that the Agenda Committee moves to approve the September 17th Senate meeting minutes as modified.

The poll vote was taken and the minutes were approved with 78% in favor, and 6% opposed.

The chair thanked everyone and invited Chancellor Kent Syverud to give his remarks.

Chancellor's Remarks

The Chancellor thanked that chair and noted that he would share brief updates. The Chancellor began by expressing his gratitude for those who helped make both Orange Central and Family Weekend very successful. He noted that we had 1,000 alumni and their families on campus for Homecoming events all over the University. He added that this year's Family Weekend was the largest in recent years, with 6,100 parents and families on campus. He thanked everyone for really showcasing our people and our campus.

Employee Benefits

Chancellor Syverud stated that Open Enrollment would begin on Monday, November 3rd. He added that the University continues to offer very highly competitive, comprehensive health benefits. He noted that health care costs were continuing to rise, and the University had been absorbing, and continues to absorb, the majority of these increases. The Chancellor stated that Human Resources has been working very hard to balance the rising costs with affordability for people.

The Chancellor stated that the good news was that there would be no increases to deductibles, co-pays, or coinsurance for any benefit plan. He noted that employee health care contributions would increase by 9% across all coverage tiers. The Chancellor added that the increases were lower than national trends, as well as being lower than those of our peer institutions and other local employers. The Chancellor acknowledged that the increase was still significant. He noted that employees with lower household incomes may qualify for Schedule B, which offers lower employee contributions. The Chancellor stated that the University was going to hold costs steady for all other benefit plans, including dental and vision.

Chancellor Syverud thanked the Employee Benefits Assessment Council, which worked very hard on this issue. He noted that the Council was created through University Senate recommendations, adding that the Council coordinated with the Human Resources team. The Chancellor added that the Council had reviewed and was in support of these changes.

Parking Update

Chancellor Syverud stated that the Parking and Transportation Services Advisory Group has been meeting weekly, and has been making good progress since the last Senate meeting. The Chancellor shared that co-chair and Chief Facilities Officer, Pete Sala and his team have been providing data, including budget and operational details to educate the group. The Chancellor stated that the focus has been on developing parking solutions for the University's lowest earners, including part-time and adjunct faculty. The Chancellor believed that they were making meaningful progress on that issue. Chancellor Syverud thanked Pete Sala, and co-chair Deirdre Joyce, as well as all the members that have been making that rapid progress. He noted that both an undergraduate student and a graduate student had been added to the group and will attend the next meeting.

AI Update

Chancellor Syverud stated that he wanted to address AI. He reported that last month, SU became one of the first universities in the nation to provide every student, faculty, and staff member with AI access through Claude by Anthropic. The Chancellor stated that Claude was the fastest-adopted software that the University has ever licensed. He noted that more than 3,500 members of our community registered and now have access to Claude. The Chancellor shared that people were using the AI platform in very different and innovative ways to work faster.

The Chancellor shared that our community was benefiting from some other new AI features too. He reported that there was an update that would allow users to integrate Microsoft 365 tools, including Teams, Outlook, OneDrive, and SharePoint, directly into Claude. The Chancellor shared that 350 attendees participated in Information Technology Services' (ITS) "AI at Work" session on October 9th, which featured a discussion on how to safely, ethically, and effectively use AI at work. Chancellor Syverud shared that he believed our community needs to embrace this opportunity to be on the leading edge of how we teach, learn, and work in this area. The Chancellor encouraged senators to create an account and explore Claude. He added that people can register by going to its.syr.edu.

Chancellor's Search Update

Chancellor Syverud shared that he had been informed that the Chancellor's search was well underway. He noted that the position description had been finalized and was available on the Chancellor Search website. The description was created based on the input received from all the community engagement sessions earlier in the semester, as well as a campus survey. The Chancellor stated that the search committee, in partnership with the search firm Spencer Stuart, had begun reviewing candidates. The Chancellor shared that the work would likely continue into the new. He noted that he was recused from the search process.

Remembrance Week

Chancellor Syverud concluded his remarks with a reminder that it was Remembrance Week when we honor those lost in Pan Am Flight 103. The Chancellor shared that the University

welcomed 10 students from the Lockerbie Academy in Scotland this week. The students spent the weekend in New York City, and they arrived on campus on Monday. They were accompanied by Headteacher Brian Asher and Deputy Headteacher Kerry Currie, who was a Lockerbie Scholar many years ago. The Chancellor stated that the Lockerbie Scholars joined the Remembrance Scholars for the "Sitting in Solidarity" event on the Quad. He added that there are a lot more events being held during the coming week. The Chancellor encouraged everybody to attend the Rose-Laying Ceremony and Convocation on Friday at the Place of Remembrance in front of the Hall of Languages. The event was slated to start at 2 p.m.

The Chancellor thanked everyone and offered to take questions after the Provost's remarks. The chair thanked Chancellor Syverud and invited Provost Lois Agnew to give her remarks.

Provost's Remarks

Provost Agnew thanked the chair and stated that she would use her time focusing on the academic portfolio review, and providing a brief overview given the discussion at the last Senate meeting. The Provost stated that she would give an overview of this process, what the goals are, what has happened, and how we've approached the process so far.

The Provost stated that the principles of the process are to look at quality and demand, the academic breadth of the institution, with a focus on mission to do strategic program assessment and to try to promote collaboration, as well as greater efficiency. The Provost stated that it wasn't really a cost-cutting exercise, it's an exercise aimed at making sure that we're meeting the needs of our students now as best we can, making sure that we are as compelling as possible to students who are increasingly looking for distinctive excellence in the institutions they choose to attend, and also making sure that our resources are appropriately allocated to support our students.

The Provost shared data on the number of programs, and the study that looked at degrees granted in a particular year, which showed that we had under 400 degrees granted in 162 programs. She added that we have many more programs than 162, which places us well above our peers of the same size in terms of the number of programs. The Provost shared data on institutions with an enrollment of between 20,000 and 25,000. She noted that with the number of degrees granted, which is not even the total number of programs we have, we stand well above most institutions our size.

Provost Agnew stated that the challenge is, among our undergraduate programs, over a 9-year average, counting students in each program where they're enrolled, 80% of our enrollments are located in only 34% of our programs, so 51 programs have 80% of the students enrolled. While 66% of the programs, in other words, 100 programs, account for just 20% of our enrollments. The Provost stated that what this means is there's an imbalance in the number of students to programs to the extent that we're having more of our resources devoted to supporting a smaller number of students, and those students in the 34% of our programs are not receiving the resources they need because there is a significant imbalance.

Provost Agnew noted that this is not to say that we should just cut things off at the 51 programs, we just can't have quite as many programs with such low enrollments and serve the needs of our students as well as we need to. She stated that in preparing for the academic portfolio review, deans were provided with a lot of data, including 9 years of duplicated enrollment data, faculty composition analysis, 5 years of course enrollment data. employment outcomes and labor market data, interactive dashboards that provide real-time access to

enrollment completion and faculty metrics, and we also provided information about doctoral time to degree and completion rates.

The Provost noted that deans were asked to consider some questions that guided their reflections on the data. She added that meetings were then held over the summer to review the data and their questions, and have them talk through how they approached reviewing and sorting the data.

Deans were asked to make preliminary classifications of the data they received, just looking at those programs that are performing very well, those programs that may not be where they need to be, but are new and innovative and just building. The Provost noted that there are some programs that seem to have declining numbers, are in low demand, or are not strategically aligned in ways that they might be.

The Provost reported that the next steps were to identify as potential outcomes, immediate closures, and those programs that were slated for immediate closure are programs that, in effect, were cases where those decisions had already been made, but the paperwork hadn't been completed.

The next category was pausing enrollment, which means not admitting for fall of 2026, The Provost stated that discussions of those programs was to take place in the fall and spring, looking at merger, consolidation, and rebranding, which are intended to improve clarity for students, making sure that we don't have students that appear to be duplicating our efforts-making sure that the way we're representing programs is clear to students. Provost Agnew stated that re-envisioning means significant curricular redesign to make sure that programs are relevant and compelling to students.

The Provost shared that the idea was to engage faculty in thinking about what their programs need to look like for the future, and creating new goals to be sure that we have the positive outcomes that we need. And finally, there are those programs that are stable, already performing well, and nothing needs to be done immediately, even though all academic programs need to be reviewed regularly just to be sure that we're keeping current.

Provost Agnew wanted to make sure that it's clear, a pause is a temporary halt to admitting new students for fall. The intention is to evaluate programs and give us an opportunity to make revisions that might make those programs more relevant or compelling. It also might be the case that everyone involved will agree that it's time to sunset those programs, and redirect our resources. This does not remove the program from the catalog, it doesn't stop the program or its courses from being taught immediately. And even if there is a decision to, sunset a program, it doesn't mean that courses in that discipline will no longer be offered.

Provost Agnew concluded her remarks stating that she hoped this has helped people to have a little bit more background about the portfolio review. Provost Agnew offered to answer questions.

The chair thanked Provost Agnew and asked if there were any questions.

Q&A

A senator directed a question to Chancellor Syverud. The senator stated that the Trump administration has asked colleges and universities to sign a federal compact for higher education. The senator asked if there was any plan for the university to sign such a compact.

Chancellor Syverud responded that in its current form, Syracuse University was not going to sign the compact. He noted that there were parts of the compact that are sensible, including parts related to veterans and military-connected students. He noted that some universities are meeting with the White House on the compact. The Chancellor stated that if that should produce any changes, he would have to consult with both the Board of Trustees and the Senate before saying or doing anything more than he'd said about the compact, which is that the University is not going to sign it in its current form.

The senator thanked the Chancellor.

Another senator began their comment by thanking the Chancellor and the Provost for being in attendance. The senator noted that it isn't all that common, and they appreciate the support for shared governance. The senator stated that it was obviously a complicated time for academic freedom and for higher education.

The senator noted that in previous remarks, the Chancellor spoke about Syracuse University taking a proactive stance. For a lot of things, proactive is good, I don't think anybody would argue with that, but it's really easy for proactivity to slide into anticipatory obedience, which many, including AAUP (American Association of University Professors) have warned against. The senator asked Chancellor Syverud at what point does proactivity slide into anticipatory obedience, and how will the Chancellor ensure that that doesn't happen at Syracuse University.

Chancellor Syverud responded that the senator asked a good question, and a complicated question. The Chancellor stated that he believed that it involves every day paying attention to details about the issues that come up that particular day. He shared that some of the lines aren't bright, but we've been trying to make the calls as they come every day. That includes studying AAUP guidelines that go way back. Chancellor Syverud stated that he didn't regard the AAUP as adversarial in this.

The Chancellor stated that it also includes paying attention to our own policies that have also been in place for a while. He stated that anticipatory obedience is partly a function of what is clear and in guidelines from various sources. He noted that much of what comes out is far from clear, adding that part of the challenge is deciding what is actually guidance or law and what isn't? What is a Truth Social post, as opposed to an actual rulemaking or promulgated rule that we have to comply with. The Chancellor acknowledged that the senator was right to be worried about exactly that, and we're trying to pay attention to it. He noted that he hears from expert faculty on this issue, and he wanted to continue to do so.

A senator asked a question regarding the academic portfolio review. The senator referenced Provost Agnew's remarks that the portfolio review was not a cost-cutting exercise, however, the Provost referred numerous times to resources. The senator asked what the Provost meant in terms of resources. The senator proposed that if resources is money, then isn't the review, in some way, a cost-cutting exercise, or predominantly a cost-cutting exercise if the goal was to reduce the number of programs to ensure that we have the correct resources to cover them all.

Provost Agnew thanked the senator, noting that they make a good point. She noted that you could define reallocation of resources as cost-cutting. What I intended to say by saying this is not a cost-cutting exercise was to say the primary purpose is not to cut costs, but to look at how we're using our resources

The Provost stated that it was true, we have to understand we have finite resources and a finite number of students, and we need to be sure that we're using our resources appropriately to support our students. We also should be using our resources to support a strong student experience. It is the case that students in a major with only 5 students across a 4-year cohort, are not going to have the same quality of experience. It's hard to have a strong major if the majors are so small in number and so scattered that it's hard to offer the courses you need, it's hard to have the kind of cohort and community you need for a strong major.

Conversely, it's hard to have a major with 600 or 800 students, that doesn't have all of the resources needed, that has very large classes, and an inadequate support structure because we have spread our resources so thin that we can't attend to the size of those majors that are on the larger size. Provost Agnew reiterated that the purpose of portfolio review was really to look at what we're providing to students, and making sure that we are using our resources in ways that reflect where the students' interests lie.

The chair thanked the Provost and senator for their comments. She noted that the meeting was very tight on time, and she asked the senators with their hands raised to be as concise as possible.

A senator thanked Provost Agnew for talking about the portfolio review. The senator wanted to mention that in the Nutrition Department, there were three programs, the Master's in Nutrition Science, the Bachelor's in Nutrition Science, and the Minor in Nutrition Science, which were not zombie programs. We had not discussed closing them whatsoever, and they were closed, not paused. The senator stated that as far as the resources, none of those programs had additional courses. All of the coursework in those programs in Falk College were also being used by our other master's, bachelor's, and minor programs. The senator wanted to point out that they weren't all under discussion for the future.

Provost Agnew thanked the senator for their comments.

Another senator asked Provost Agnew about what the motivation would be for pausing a program. The senator suggested that pausing is freshmen or prospective students applying won't see that on the list of possible majors. The senator noted that students still here will see it in the catalog. So, if no decision has been made to actually terminate these programs. The senator didn't quite understand what the advantage would be by pausing them for next year in the way that's being done, and not advertising them as potential options to incoming students.

Provost Agnew responded that the list of paused programs, for the most part, includes programs that have between 10 and no students across the entire major. The Provost stated that it's really important to take the time to look at those programs and figure out what makes sense going forward, and to admit students or to recruit students into a program that has 3, 4, or 5 majors total promises those students four years of an education, and with an experience that we can't necessarily vouch for. The Provost added that what we've found is that students admitted into those programs that don't have a strong incoming cohort, often wind up not coming after we've admitted them, or they have a higher attrition rate than students in more thriving programs. So, it's important to look at the big picture for all of us and figure out how we can make sure that all of our programs have the opportunity to help students succeed, that we bring students into programs that we have really looked carefully at, and are sure that we have a long-term success plan for those programs.

The chair thanked Chancellor Syverud and Provost Agnew. The Chair invited Rick DiRubbo, co-chair of the Committee on Curriculum & Instruction to present the committee's report.

Committee on Curriculum & Instruction

Mr. DiRubbo thanked that chair and welcomed everyone in attendance. He noted that the committee didn't have any curriculum to vote on for the October report. Mr. DiRubbo stated that he would provide a quick overview of what the committee had been working on.

Mr. DiRubbo stated that for the committee's last couple of meetings, the members have had discussions on what our role should be regarding curriculum processes, specifically around some of the issues that have come up with the IDEA courses, shared competencies, and program closures. Mr. DiRubbo noted that these discussions would continue.

Mr. DiRubbo reported that the committee's main initiatives for the year

- The committee has reviewed a number of course proposals and new subject requests that will be presented to the Senate in the committee's November Report.
- The committee has identified five subcommittees to look at a number of continuing and new initiatives that impact curriculum and the work of the committee.
- The committee will be collaborating with the Registrar's Office on their efforts to develop a new curriculum management platform for the University.

Mr. DiRubbo also reviewed the committee subcommittee initiatives:

- Group A – Meet with senior faculty in Arts & Sciences to summarize and present the changes in the A&S Liberal Arts Core (continued from last year)
- Group B – Look at the current process of reviewing IDEA courses and how it can be adapted into a new set of procedures. Work with the Office of Institutional Effectiveness and Assessment (IEA), to bring shared competencies into any new curriculum system processes.
- Group C – Review the processes involved in schools and colleges across campus related to curriculum review for new programs, new subject codes, new courses, course regularizations, course inactivations, program revisions, pauses, and closures.
- Group D – Discuss whether attendance and participation requirements across campus, including whether credit should be given purely for attendance (resurrecting a previous policy discussion) and establishing an official policy for attendance during the Drop/Add period.
- Group E – Examine the compliance for NYSED requirements for 8-week courses and different modalities, as we transition online programs from quarters to three semesters with two courses per semester; provide recommendations for making courses that are simultaneously taught online and in-person consistent in terms of grading.

Mr. DiRubbo concluded his report by thanking the committee members, noting that he believed the SCCI was one of the hardest-working groups. He also thanked Senate Affairs manager, Kelly Bogart for all the work that she does working with the committee.

The chair thanked Mr. DiRubbo and asked if there were questions for the Curriculum & Instruction Committee. As there were none, the chair invited the Committee on Research & Creative Scholarship to report, presented by Senator Brian Lonsway.

Committee on Research and Creative Scholarship

Senator Lonsway began his report noting that because the committee was reporting early in the Senate term, the report would cover work from the previous year and planning for the year to come.

Senator Lonsway shared an overview of how the committee was merged during the Senate restructure and the new committee structure is beginning to work in its new form. Senator Lonsway shared the committee's focus areas for the year ahead.

- impacts of federal actions on academic freedom in research & creative scholarship at SU (cooperation with AFTPE)
- assessment of research/creative scholarship impacts of program pauses
- AI research/creative scholarship and support across SU
- definitions/understandings of creative scholarship and opportunities for library support

Senator Lonsway shared the 2024-25 task group committee goals and objectives:

- Marketing and communication
promoting and disseminating faculty research. More specifically, identify and define use cases, identify pain points, and identify needs that are not currently addressed
- Centers and Institutes
understanding their status, funding, reporting structures and management
- Artificial Intelligence
explore the state of artificial intelligence (AI) research across Syracuse University and identify opportunities to facilitate new research, along with critical investments in infrastructure
- Library Initiatives
develop a working definition of 'Creative Scholarship' aligned with the committee's charge through stakeholder consultation, and to advance library advocacy initiatives around resources, digitization, and special collections in support of research excellence

Senator Lonsway also shared the task group's outcomes and recommendations:

- Marketing and communication
initiated the development of a list of use cases for research/creative scholarship marketing and communication to assist units with identifying strategies and means of support, it identifies five use cases with Purpose, Audience, Tools, Desired Outcomes, and Pain Points
- Centers and Institutes
consulted on the review of the University's policy on "Management of Related Entities, Internal Organizations, and Licensed Operations" and the "Centers and Institutes Policy," which currently have conflicting requirements
- Artificial Intelligence
outlined a provisional taxonomy for kinds of AI research and creative scholarship at SU (subjects and issues) for proposed AY 25-26 self-reporting survey: Foundational AI, Applied AI, Meta-AI
- Library Initiatives
consulted library leadership, reviewed SU's current definition of Creative Scholarship, reviewed SU Library's strategic plan, examined existing review instruments, and

reviewed information literacy programs and resources to help frame a model of library support and celebration for faculty creative scholarship

Senator Lonsway noted that there were additional committee deliberations with regards to:

Observe a changing research landscape

- In January 2025, the research landscape across the United States began to change drastically due to federal executive actions and orders. The committee discussed on numerous occasions what role and agency it could play in the rapidly evolving landscape.
- Consulted closely with Duncan Brown, Vice President for Research, who was actively tracking and adapting university initiatives to contend with the changes. The committee saw its role at that time primarily as interlocutor among our members' multiple constituencies, the Senate, and the administration through the Office of Research.

Moving forward into the 2025-26 academic year:

For the committee task group, next steps will be

Reforming Task Groups with the goal to observe, study, and report on:

- impacts of federal actions on academic freedom in research & creative scholarship at SU (cooperation with AFTPE)
- assessment of research impacts of program pauses
- AI research and research support across SU
- definitions/understandings of creative scholarship and opportunities for library support

For the full committee, next steps will be policy reviews and recommendations on:

- interim policy on Faculty Course Buy Out
- interim policy on Research Laboratory Safety and Accountability
- proposed updates to policies on centers and institutes
- policies on faculty workload and research leave
- policy and procedures regarding research misconduct

Senator Lonsway reiterated the committee's selected focus areas and noted that he would like to hear any feedback that he could bring back to any members of the committee that aren't already in attendance, on any of the focus areas or other topics related to the committee's mission. Senator Lonsway thanked everyone.

The chair thanked Senator Lonsway and asked if there were any questions or feedback for the committee or Senator Lonsway.

A senator thanked Senator Lonsway for his report, noting that it was very helpful. The senator then asked how the university was supporting faculty through resources, and whether the committee was going to look at where monies are being distributed and in what percentages, and who the faculty and the colleges are receiving them, so that we understand how faculty are being supported in the research endeavors that they take on.

Senator Lonsway thanked the senator and asked for clarification and if the senator meant to ask how research funding is allocated from internal sources.

The senator responded by indicating “funding in various forms”.

Senator Lonsway responded that it currently wasn't on the committee's agenda for the year, but he stated that he would definitely bring it back to the committee. Senator Lonsway stated that he believed that we are a body that certainly can serve an important role in that, and he thanked the senator again for their question.

The senator followed up their question by noting that it was important, especially given how the attack on certain aspects of universities is directly impacting people's ability to do research.

Senator Lonsway responded that one thing that he learned while co-chairing the committee last year was, for example, the Office of Research's efforts to align funding initiatives and pools of financial resources that were allocated for faculty research support to those whose research may have been directly impacted or funding cut from federal initiatives.

Particularly in the case of those who are on the tenure track and have pending reappointment or tenure cases coming ahead, to help mitigate those impacts. Senator Lonsway stated that he didn't know the dollar amounts to those, but that's something the committee can certainly look into, and he thanked the senator again for their feedback.

The chair thanked Senator Lonsway for his report. She then stated that the next item on the agenda would be the resolution on portfolio review. She invited Senator Matthew Mulvaney to present.

Resolution on Portfolio Review

Senator Mulvaney thanked the chair and everyone in attendance. Senator Mulvaney noted that he was standing in for Senator Crystal Bartolovich, who unfortunately couldn't attend the meeting. Senator Mulvaney provided a brief overview of the resolution, and maybe most importantly, the revised resolution.

Senator Mulvaney shared that it was his understanding that Senator Bartolovich and Provost Agnew engaged in complex discussion and negotiation about the wording of the resolution, and Senator Bartolovich brought the results of those negotiations back to the original 15 signatories of the resolution. Senator Mulvaney noted that there was discussion and differing viewpoints, but the general consensus among all of the original signatories was that the changed wording was acceptable, in terms of its change.

Senator Mulvaney noted that he felt that there was a general consensus that the most important part was to engage the Senate in this very important process. Therefore, the resolution is being brought back to the Senate with the changed language. Senator Mulvaney asked that senators note the difference in the language from the original resolution. He expressed his gratitude to Senator Bartolovich and Provost Agnew for engaging in the conversation to bring it forth.

Senator Mulvaney took a moment to share his own perspective on the issue. Senator Mulvaney stated that he believed what makes American universities great, what has made Syracuse University great over these years, has been shared governance and both the spirit and the process of that activity, and the intersection of that has always been the Senate. The University Senate has been the place for a sounding board and a collective representation of a wide number of constituents at Syracuse University to come together to deliberate and debate and to put forth, via voting processes, the best ideas that we can to improve Syracuse

University. Everybody's committed to Syracuse University and wants it to thrive in the best way that it can.

Senator Mulvaney stated that the basic idea of academic shared governance is that those faculty, who are in the trenches teaching students and those scholars who are producing cutting-edge research and knowledge, are important constituents to be engaged with in determining the academic process. And that the implications of individual considerations of departments are significant for the university as a whole.

In that spirit, we ask that there is formal deliberation at the Senate. Senator Mulvaney shared that he hoped that this was the beginning of the discussion, the beginning of the process for considering how the Senate may best engage with these very complex and difficult questions. And in the spirit of shared governance, bring this to the Senate with a respectful request for consideration.

The chair thanked Senator Mulvaney and noted that in the interest of accessibility, she asked Senator Mulvaney to read the resolution aloud so that everybody has heard it.

Senator Mulvaney read the revised resolution into the record.

"Be it resolved that the Syracuse University Senate affirms the primary control of the faculty over the curriculum. It also asserts that the Portfolio Review should have a formal Senate component following the review process at the college level. To assure the integrity of the process in the colleges, a senate committee designated by the Agenda Committee will review and address concerns raised by faculty or students in the colleges. The Senate as a whole will review a draft of the composite results and recommendations of the Portfolio review to consider academic balance, overlaps and collective identity of the institution as a whole."

The chair thanked Senator Mulvaney and opened the floor for discussion.

A senator noted that the phrase portfolio review should have review either with an uppercase R or a lowercase r, but not one of each.

The chair thanked the senator for their feedback.

Provost Agnew took an opportunity to thank Senator Crystal Bartolovich for engaging with her in this conversation about how we can secure what we had always intended, which was Senate participation. The Provost noted that they'd presented on the portfolio review to the Academic Affairs Committee and have intended to continue doing that over the course of the year, but we welcome the opportunity to share information about the portfolio review with whomever the Senate would like. She reiterated that it was always the goal to have participation and to gather feedback from faculty, and so she appreciated the opportunity to talk this through with Senator Bartolovich during the course of revising the resolution.

The chair thanked Provost Agnew and asked for any further discussion.

A senator noted as a matter of parliamentary procedure, the senator considered this as a new resolution, and as such, it should be moved and seconded. It's significantly different. The senator suggested that Senator Mulvaney make a formal motion and it should be seconded.

The chair discussed proper procedure with the Senate parliamentarian, and it was decided that as a significantly different resolution, it should have a second.

Senator PJ DiPietro seconded the motion.

The chair thanked Senator DiPietro. The chair asked if there was additional discussion, comments, or questions.

Senator DiPietro asked to make a friendly amendment to the resolution to say "*the Senate in its entirety*", so that we don't repeat "as a whole", and "as a whole" in that sentence, which created ambiguity.

The chair asked if the friendly amendment was acceptable to Senator Mulvaney. Senator Mulvaney responded that he had no objections as it seems like a friendly amendment and a minor change to the resolution.

The Parliamentarian shared that it was a friendly amendment, and it wouldn't require a seconder.

The chair asked if there was any additional discussion. As there was none, the chair asked for the poll to allow Senator Mulvaney to make the motion on the revised resolution.

"Be it resolved that the Syracuse University Senate affirms the primary control of the faculty over the curriculum. It also asserts that the Portfolio Review should have a formal Senate component following the review process at the college level. To assure the integrity of the process in the colleges, a senate committee designated by the Agenda Committee will review and address concerns raised by faculty or students in the colleges. The Senate in its entirety will review a draft of the composite results and recommendations of the Portfolio Review to consider academic balance, overlaps and collective identity of the institution as a whole."

Senator Mulvaney moved to approve the revised resolution. Senator PJ DiPietro seconded the motion.

The chair thanked Senators Mulvaney and DiPietro and the poll vote was taken. The resolution was approved with 81% in favor. The chair thanked everyone for their participation.

The chair raised the next item on the agenda - old business. The chair asked if there was any old business.

Senator Kendra DeLoach McCutcheon asked the chair for a point of order. The chair acknowledged the senator's request. The senator recalled back to the resolution and asked if the Senate was voting on the amendment to the resolution, or the main resolution.

The chair responded that the discussion and vote was on the main resolution. The amendment was a friendly amendment, so it did not require a vote, and the vote was then on the amended resolution.

The senator thanked the chair for the clarification.

Old Business

The chair again asked if there was any old business. As there was none, the chair asked if there was any new business.

New Business

As there was none, the Agenda Committee then moved to adjourn the meeting. The meeting adjourned at 5:08 pm

Attendees

Agnew, Lois (Provost)
Almandrez, Mary Grace
Almeyda, Melissa
Arnold, Philip
Ashby, Christy
Barnes, Kristen
Bowman, Nick
Brandes, Pamela
Brown, Harriet
Brown, Lori
Bryant, Joan
Bulman, Gail
Caliz Casanova, Ana
Campbell, Kelly
Cass, Peter
Catalino, Karrie
Chandler-Olcott, Kelly
Chapman, Gabrielle
Chernobai, Anna
Combs, Michele
Costello Staniec, Andria
Cutler, Dan
Dagg, Adrienne
DaSilva, Tommy
Dekaney, Elisa
DeLoach McCutcheon, Kendra
Dharwadkar, Ravi
Dima, Vlad
DiPietro, PJ
Dismuke, Vanessa
Dixon, Sheriah
Dohne, Deborah
Dunham, Christopher
Ebner, Michael
Eiffe, Chris
Endeladze, Qeti
Erdman, Maria
Estevez-Abe, Margarita
Eversole, Britt
Fathers, James
Faulkner, Carol
Fleckenstein, Jan
Fonger, Nicole
Frasciello, Michael
Gaines, Heather
Giannini, Stefano
Giles, Patricia
Gitsov, Ivan
Glazman-Schillinger, Ian
Goenka, Tula
Gonzalez, Asher
Gorovitz, Sam
Graham, Jennifer
Graham, Mary
Granger, Reed
Grimes, Diane
Hagenloh, Paul

Hallas, Roger
Harter, Don
Hasenwinkel, Julie
Heckman, Denise
Hepburn, Adam
Jiang, Hua
Kallander, Amy
Kameir, Rawiya
Kinsey, Dennis
Klaver, Coran
Kornfilt, Jaklin
Kutcher, Norman
Lachut, Max
Lasch-Quinn, Elisabeth
Leach, Alexis
Leonard, Kincaid
Lewis, Kate
Liu, Xiyuan
Lonsway, Brian
Lopez, Gretchen
L'Pree Corsbie-Massay,
Charisse
Madero, Gustavo
Martinez, Armando
McCoy, Amy
McKnight, Lee
Miller, Cameron
Miller, Claudia
Mirer, Anna
Mitchell, Michelle
Mitra, Devashish
Moradian, Soudabeh
Morgan, Glyn
Morton, Laurel
Mulvaney, Matthew
Nangia, Shikha
Nolivos, German
Nordquist, Brice
Oh, David
Oh, Jae
Patin, Beth
Perreault, Thomas
Peter, Pam
Possenti-Perez, Paula
Raina, Ramesh
Reed Kantrowitz, Rebecca
Rhodes, Nancy Keefe
Robinson, Briell
Rojas Betanzos, Ruben
Roland-Silverstein, Kathleen
Russo, Natalie
Saluti, Andrew
Sanders, Shane
Schell, Eileen
Schimpff, Tracey Reichert
Sharma Paudel, Basanta
Smith, Cole

Starr, Bijan
Stokes-Rees, Emily
Straub, Beck
Strony, Jera
Syverud, Kent (Chancellor)
Tapia, James
Teres, Harvey
Terrell, Robert
Thomas, Susan
Thompson, Peggy
Tochelli, Erin
Toenniessen, Ray
Todorova, Svetla
Van Gulick, Robert
Van Slyke, David
Walker, Kristin
Westlund, Haley
Williams, Ryan C.
Winders, Jamie
Yung, Douglas
Zadzilka, Joyce